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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 5

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Notes

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 5 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 5 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word, and one or two wrong answers very rarely do. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 242 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code page (S2-02) takes longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-15, S2-20) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as discount, GST and interest stories, rate stories, tank stories and angles found in two steps, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Figures of triangles, cuboids, tanks and angles are original drawings. The figures are sketches: a pupil should use the numbers and facts on the page, not a ruler or a protractor. The one exception is P5-28 (Height Hunt), which says that its figures are drawn accurately so that a right angle can be checked with the corner of a sheet of paper.
- **Not covered.** A printed page cannot check a pupil who draws (a cuboid on an isometric grid, a triangle of a given area) or who builds with real cubes. These verbs of the syllabus are practised only by reading drawings; the plan lists them. Ratio, average, pie charts, fraction division, finding the whole from a percentage, percentage change, circles and algebra are not used in these booklets.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large enough for handwriting. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size). The small figures in the route and colour pages need a clear copy: use normal toner, not a light setting.

Pictures are not actual size.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P5-21	How Many Percent?	1 star
S2-02	P5-22	Colour the Butterfly	1 star
S2-03	P5-23	Sale Prices	2 stars
S2-04	P5-24	GST Match	2 stars
S2-05	P5-25	Annual Interest	2 stars
S2-06	P5-26	Rate Cards	1 star
S2-07	P5-27	Rate Stories	2 stars
S2-08	P5-28	Height Hunt	1 star
S2-09	P5-29	Triangle Areas	1 star
S2-10	P5-30	Triangle Route	2 stars
S2-11	P5-31	Composite Figures	2 stars
S2-12	P5-32	Count the Cubes	1 star
S2-13	P5-33	Cuboid Volumes	1 star
S2-14	P5-34	Tank Match	2 stars
S2-15	P5-35	Tank Tales	2 stars
S2-16	P5-36	Angle Route	1 star
S2-17	P5-37	Find the Angle	1 star
S2-18	P5-38	Triangle Angles	1 star
S2-19	P5-39	Shape Statements	2 stars
S2-20	P5-40	Angle Chains	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P5-01 to P5-40).

What the booklet covers

Percentage 1.1 expressing a part of a whole as a percentage **S2-01, S2-02**

Percentage 1.2 use of % **S2-01, S2-02**

Percentage 1.3 finding a percentage part of a whole **S2-02, S2-03, S2-04, S2-05**

Percentage 1.4 finding discount, GST and annual interest **S2-02, S2-03, S2-04, S2-05**

Rate 1.1 rate as the amount of a quantity per unit of another quantity **S2-06, S2-07**

Rate 1.2 finding rate, total amount or number of units given the other two quantities **S2-06, S2-07**

Area of Triangle 1.1 concepts of base and height of a triangle **S2-08, S2-09**

Area of Triangle 1.2 area of triangle **S2-09, S2-10, S2-11**

Area of Triangle 1.3 finding the area of composite figures made up of rectangles, squares and triangles **S2-11**

Volume 2.1 building solids with unit cubes **S2-12**

Volume 2.2 measuring volume in cubic units, cm^3/m^3, excluding conversion between cm^3 and m^3 **S2-13**

Volume 2.3 drawing cubes and cuboids on isometric grid **S2-12**

Volume 2.4 volume of a cube/cuboid **S2-12, S2-13, S2-14, S2-15**

Volume 2.5 finding the volume of liquid in a rectangular tank **S2-15**

Volume 2.6 relationship between ℓ (or mℓ) with cm^3 **S2-14, S2-15**

Geometry 1.1 angles on a straight line **S2-16, S2-17, S2-20**

Geometry 1.2 angles at a point **S2-16, S2-17**

Geometry 1.3 vertically opposite angles **S2-16, S2-17, S2-20**

Geometry 1.4 finding unknown angles **S2-16, S2-17, S2-18, S2-20**

Geometry 2.1 properties of isosceles triangle, equilateral triangle, right-angled triangle **S2-18, S2-20**

Geometry 2.2 angle sum of a triangle **S2-18, S2-20**

Geometry 2.3 finding unknown angles without additional construction of lines **S2-18, S2-20**

Geometry 3.1 properties of parallelogram, rhombus, trapezium **S2-19**

Geometry 3.2 finding unknown angles without additional construction of lines **S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 2.1; Whole Numbers 2.2; Whole Numbers 2.3; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 2.1; Fractions 2.2; Fractions 2.3; Fractions 2.4; Fractions 2.5; Decimals 1.1; Decimals 1.2.